Estimation

Size work together quickly with planning poker, T-shirt sizes or affinity estimation, or decide not to estimate.

Iterate · Planning Poker · T-Shirt Sizing · Affinity Estimation · Relative, Not Absolute

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 6 May

1 Planning Poker

FOR A HANDFUL OF ITEMS

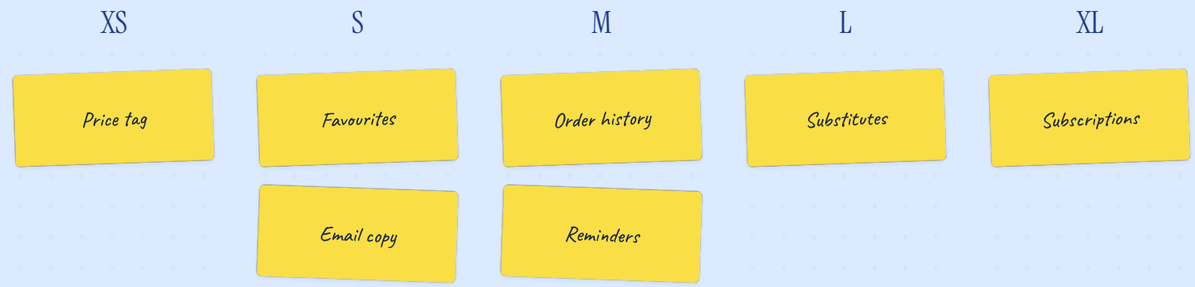
1	2	3	5	8	13	20	?	☕

1. Read the item
2. Pick a card privately
3. Reveal together
4. Highest and lowest explain
5. Re-vote, two rounds at most

ITEM	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ESTIMATE
Reorder from order history	3, 8, 5, 5	5	5
Save favourites	2, 3, 3, 2	3	3
Suggest substitutes	5, 13, 8, 8	8, 8, 8, 13	8 (split it)

2 T-Shirt Sizing

FOR MANY ITEMS, ROUGHLY

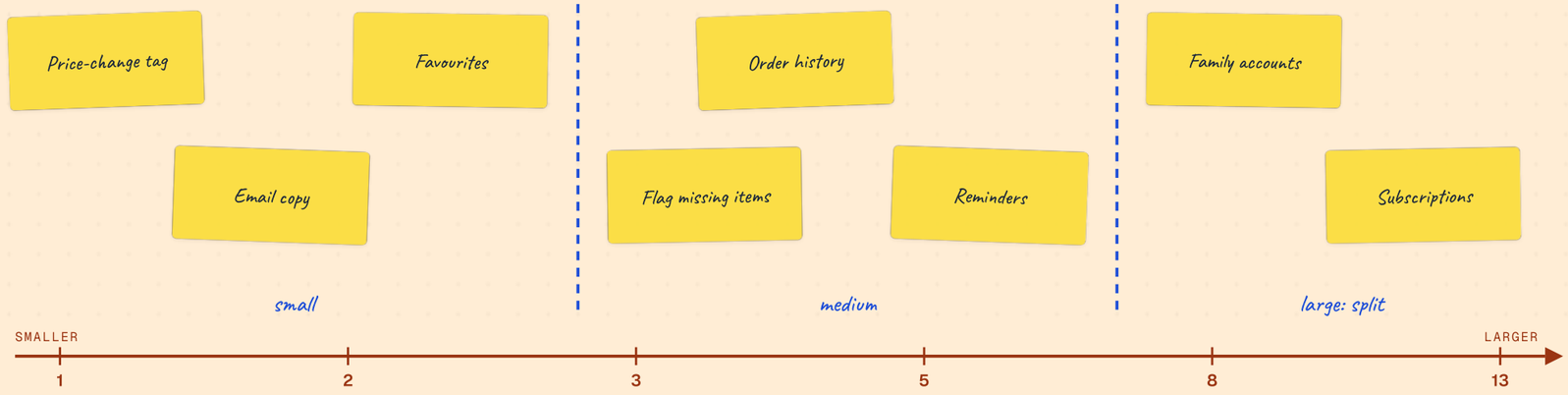


Reference item that is an “M”: reorder events (6 days)

3 Affinity Estimation

FOR A WHOLE BACKLOG IN AN HOUR

- Silently place items left to right, smallest to largest. Anyone can move any item.
- Then discuss items that keep moving, and draw size boundaries.



4 Reference Items

SHARED EXAMPLES KEEP SIZES CONSISTENT

SIZE	ITEM EVERYONE REMEMBERS	WHY THIS SIZE
S	Email confirmation	one screen, no new data
M	Reorder events	new data, privacy check
L	Order history	three screens, new API

5 Or Don't Estimate

COUNTING ITEMS OFTEN FORECASTS JUST AS WELL

- If items are split small enough to finish within your SLE, count them instead of sizing them.
- Forecast from throughput with the Release Forecast board.

- [x] We'll try counting items instead of estimating for 2 iterations, then compare

6 Ground Rules

- [x] Estimates belong to the people doing the work
- [x] An estimate is a forecast, not a promise
- [x] Never compare points between teams

“Is this bigger or smaller than the last thing we finished?”

“Do we need a number, or do we just need to know it's small?”

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